politics. While politics in India has come a long way, governments still believe they need to appeal to identity politics and that economic reforms do not win elections.

In the sphere of foreign policy, India is still wedded to old ideas and British-era structures. ‘Institution building has not been our strength,’ observed a former foreign secretary.[19] But as Subrahmanyam stated, ‘Ours is a ritualistic society. We are used to creating institutions and formulating processes without any intention of putting them to use.’ [20] According to K.S. Bajpai, Indians believe in individuals rather than institutions. It is a legacy India inherited from the Mughals through the British down to present times. Although institutions were ostensibly developed, and India has many, but ‘as far as policymaking is concerned, it is still a handful of people who decide in a somewhat ad hoc manner’. Bajpai felt that he didn’t know of any country, other than the United States, ‘where so much expertise is brought into policymaking to so little effect’.[21]

Indian policymaking depends on the vision and will of its leader of the time and is run through networks of personal relationships. Since his election in 2014, Narendra Modi has articulated a new vision, demonstrated the will to change things and is creating the networks that might bring about that change. But the institutions of governance created by the British, including the civil service and the armed forces, were trained to think within predetermined parameters. Leaders, from Nehru to Modi, have promised to ‘restore’ India to its eminence.

India is, by all measures, an extremely significant country. However, the experience of the last seventy years leads one to wonder whether greatness as envisaged by India’s leaders can be made to materialize by institutions designed to maintain a colonial enterprise. India’s bureaucrats are wedded to the status quo even when India’s people want to enter the twenty-first century as part of a new global order. India’s history is its asset as well as a great burden. The fact that the country has existed for millennia creates